

industry. Candidates might explore the purpose of the music video and ask whether *Riptide* is offering variation for artistic reasons or to generate interest in the band to make a profit.

PART 2: STARTING POINTS – Representation

Social and Cultural Contexts:

Consider the context of the music video in terms of the **texts** and media **forms** it **references** and explore the significance of these texts in relation to the way women in particular are represented. Candidates could watch sequences from Buñuel and Dalí's *Un Chien Andalou* (1929) to explore surrealist film, considering the way this film explores violence and sexual desire in a way that might **inform the music video**. The infamous eye cutting scene in *Un Chien Andalou* for instance could be compared to the hand stabbing scene the music video. A brief exploration of the **subconscious** might also afford the chance to add depth to a discussion of the representation issues in the video and its sometimes dream-like logic.

Consider how media representations convey values, attitudes and beliefs about the world:

- The video offers many interesting examples of the representation of women - consider whether or not the video reinforces a **patriarchal** world view or is **subverting** the objectification of women in media.
- **Women** in the video are repeatedly presented as an **object** to be watched:
 - » In one shot a woman with her back to the camera undresses out of her swimming costume and there are a number of instances where we see disembodied, isolated sections of women's bodies such as bare feet running away or feminine hands being dragged out of shot.
 - » Consider whether these images of women are **sexualised** and offered to audiences for their pleasure (scopophilia) or presented in a way that **challenges** the sexualisation of women in many music videos.
 - » Explore the **lip-synch sections** where a woman sings the lyrics of the song into a microphone. At first she has immaculate

make-up and is framed and lit in a flattering way arguably **conforming to social norms** of beauty and glamour associated with mainstream media texts. As we repeatedly return to this character she becomes increasingly dishevelled, her make-up smudges and her expression becomes more and more vacant as she sings "*the words wrong*". Discuss the extent to which this representation **challenges gender representation** in music video and how it sits with the other representations of women in the video.

- Along with the representations of women the music video also presents a number of scenes that offer images of **violence**, such as a female hand being stabbed by a knife and a gun being pointed off screen. The lip-synching woman also clutches at her own neck and we see what seems to be blood over her hand. Candidates may discuss why these images are used in the video and whether they may be **trivialising or normalising** violence.

Consider theoretical perspectives:

Theories of Identity – David Gauntlett

- Use Gauntlett to explore complex and diverse representations in the music video - his concept of the **pick and mix** seems particularly relevant to the style of the video which constructs a range of different stimuli that the audience are invited to interpret. The video rejects singular, straightforward messages and instead invites a **variety of different responses and interpretations**.

A level only:

Feminist Theory – bell hooks

- Hooks could be used as a stimulus to explore the seemingly **contradictory messages** about **gender** in the video. Is the video **objectifying** women in an ironic or knowing way or is it instead feeding into the **oppression** of women in a patriarchal society? Use hooks' position that **feminism is a struggle to end sexist/patriarchal oppression** to ask whether the video is part of that struggle or part of the oppression.